



SELECTBOARD
TOWN OF WESTHAMPTON
1 South Road, Westhampton, Massachusetts 01027



Minutes of the Meeting

Tuesday, September 8, 2026, 7:00 PM, at The Town Hall, 1 South Road

Call to Order

The Selectboard was called to order by BRONSTEIN at 7:02 PM

PRESENT: Susan Bronstein (Chair), Jennifer Milikowsky, Scott Johndrow

ALSO PRESENT: Patrick Grigsby, others as noted.

Public Comment

Public are invited to comment on any item not on the agenda.

PRESENT: Agricultural Commission Chair Steve Holt

Chair Holt raised the issue of Fixed Costs.

PRESENT: Building Inspector Todd Alexander

Building Inspector Alexander brought administrative paperwork to sign.

Tree Cutting for Power Lines on Spruce Hill Road

Discussion by Mr. Christopher Dunn of cutting trees on Spruce Hill Road owned by the Town. Mr. Dunn offered to have a private logger trim the trees and keep a portion of wood as payment and will return when he hears back from the state Department of Environmental Protection about questions related to this project.

Chicken Manure Fertilizer Concern

Discussion of Massachusetts laws related to regulation of chicken manure as fertilizer and the impact of this practice on wells. Ms. Milikowsky pointed out that concerns about wells would be a matter the Board of Health would oversee not the Selectboard. Discussion of the role of the Agricultural Commission or the Selectboard in resolving disputes related to the use of chicken manure as fertilizer. Selectboard decided that they can make recommendations to the disputing parties in this case based on a report from Agricultural Commission but that neither body can make a legally binding decision.

Chair Holt stated that the Agricultural Commission reviewed Massachusetts state laws related to this matter and found that this farmer's use of chicken manure was not in violation of state law.

Board and Committee Updates

Chair Holt: The Agricultural Commission met and discussed the definition of a farm. In the future, they hope to make a final decision and post this online.

Ms. Milikowsky noted that minutes must be provided to anyone who requests them – even if still in a draft form. This does not apply to minutes still in the form of notes. The Right to Farm bylaw only applies to farms that engage in commercial agriculture.

Building Inspector Alexander asked the Selectboard to sign two documents related to a MEMA Grant and a Certification of Compliance with Foreign National Vetting Requirements.

MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow to

Give Susan Bronstein the power to sign the MEMA Grant document/

VOTED (3,0,0)

MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow to

Give Patrick Grigsby the power to review and sign the Certification of Compliance with Foreign National Vetting Requirements.

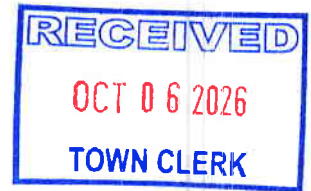
VOTED (3,0,0)

Discussion of setting up separate emails for Commission heads. Selectboard agreed on the need to do so but Chair



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Bronstein stated the town cannot do this in the immediate future because of the costs.

PRESENT: Building Inspector Wally Marek

Building Inspector Marek asked if Selectboard would approve of the Building Inspectors reaching out to the Zoning, Conservation, and Planning Commissions to ask them to give one contact on these boards to talk with the Building Inspectors on issues that arise day to day relevant to each board. The Selectboard agreed with this idea.

Ms. Lynn Fournier discussed the preparation for a Halloween Party in the Town.

MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow to

Approve Halloween Festival Plan as presented by Lynn Fournier

VOTED (3,0,0)

Administrative Matters

Review of Correspondence (board may act on any correspondence as received)

Town Administrator Report

Town Administrator Grigsby reported that the Town had applied to the Winter Recovery Assistance Program (WRAP) Extraordinary Hardship Grant. If awarded in full, this grant would reimburse the town for costs associated with snow and ice removal clearing from the 2025-2026 winter, and pay for the resurfacing of Kings Highway, Mine Road, and Chesterfield Road.

The Selectboard approved sending a warning letter by certified mail to the resident at 61 Chesterfield Road requiring them to obtain a permit for their dog and take precautions to prevent their dog becoming a danger to other residents.

Town Administrator Grigsby presented a plan for town employees to start tracking their hours for one month and create Standard Administrative Procedures (SAPs) detailing the processes necessary to perform their work. In the plan, the Town Administrator and Selectboard would also track their hours. Chair Bronstein suggested increasing the time hours are tracked to longer than one month. Ms. Milikowsky suggested making the timesheet a weekly report of hours instead of tracking an employee's clock-in and clock-out hours. The Selectboard decided to continue discussing this idea and take it up at the next Selectboard meeting.

Review of Legal Requirements Around Accountant Term

No discussion of this issue since it had been solved between the posting of the agenda and the Selectboard meeting. The Town Accountant serves for a term of three years.

Review and approval of minutes of past meetings

MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow to:

Approve 8/25 Minutes as edited.

VOTED (3,0,0)

Review and approval of AP and Payroll Warrants (W27-05, WP27-05)

MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow to:

Approve W27-05

VOTED (3,0,0)

Member Concerns

MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow to:

Give Susan the power to sign a reimbursement request by Cherie Pease for transportation to Westfield Technical Academy. Ms. Milikowsky noted this is the least expensive option for the town to fulfil its state-



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mandated requirements to provide transportation to residents seeking vocational education for their children.

VOTED (3,0,0)

Adjourn

MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow to:

Adjourn

VOTED (3,0,0) (8:25

PM)

Approved by a vote of the Selectboard at a regular meeting, held on _____

Susan Bronstein, Chair

Susan Bronstein

Jennifer Milikowsky, Selectboard Member

Jennifer Milikowsky

Scott Johndrow, Selectboard Member

Scott Johndrow